

BRING HOME THE BANK

Through Internet, phone and mobile, banks are ready to reach you anywhere, any time. What's more, the benefits of home banking are much more than savings in time, hassle, paperwork and money. Get the most out of branchless banking.

■ By **Sushmita Choudhury and Narayan Krishnamurthy**

In the past few months Madhur Vohra's financial life has shrunk into the 15-inch monitor of his computer screen. What started as a tentative step into online banking two years ago has transformed into his anywhere, anytime one-click personal finance manager. From tracking and paying for his three credit cards, to sending money to his parents in Indore, to repaying his home and personal loans to settling all his utility bills, the Delhi-based back-office employee does everything from home—or office. He is neither a tech geek nor a financial wizard, but he has achieved what the masters in technology and finance haven't: organised all his finances under one simple webpage. The benefits are much more than savings in time, hassle, paperwork and money. The middle-income class Vohra is not only banking easy, he is also banking more than ever before. "All I wanted was to take banking out of the bank. What I have achieved in the process is nothing short of financial empowerment and in some ways, even financial emancipation," he says. He is the average urban Indian with ordinary income and unenviable investments, but by using home banking (a combination of online,

phone and mobile banking) intelligently he has organised his finances in a way that he now knows exactly where, when and how much he spends every month.

What Vohra unintentionally stumbled upon is something most Indians

are unintentionally not embracing. The power of banking from outside the bank's branch.

ALL CONVENIENCE, NO COST

A decade ago, more so in the last seven years, the ATM took away the wearisome teller from our lives. Now, home banking has cut off the entire branch and turned it into



\$6 bn (Rs 24,300 cr)

The estimated yearly saving if India fully shifts to an e-payment system.

95%

Is the potential reduction in cost by shifting to non-branch banking.

5 times

More transactions now take place via e-banking than inside a branch.

16 million

Indians will be banking online by end 2007, up from 4.6 million in 2006.